

Average time to close the gap. On average, it takes about 4 days for price to cover the gap, regardless of market condition or gap direction. In bull markets, when price gaps upward, the closing time is 1 day longer than the other varieties.

Percentage closed. The table shows the closure rates. Nearly all of the area gaps close in the first week or two. You can scan down the other tables to see the closure rate compared to area gaps and verify that area gaps close a lot faster (in days, not weeks or months) than the other types.

[Table 36.2](#) General Statistics: Area Gaps

Description	Bull Market, Up Gap	Bear Market, Up Gap	Bull Market, Down Gap	Bear Market, Down Gap
Number found	403	196	429	112
Average days to close the gap	5	4	4	4
Closed in 1 week	85%	92%	90%	88%
Closed in 2 weeks	99%	100%	100%	100%
Average gap height	\$0.26	\$0.47	\$0.20	\$0.48

Average gap size. Area gaps in bear markets are about twice as tall as those in bull markets. Why this is the case is a mystery to me. The smallest gaps occur in bull markets, with a downward direction (price gaps downward).

That makes intuitive sense if you think of the bull market as a current going in one direction and a down gap as gapping in the opposite direction (downward). It's like trying to ride a bicycle against the wind. However, if that's really the case, then why is the up gap in bull markets also showing a small gap (both are moving in the same direction)? I don't know.

Statistics: Breakaway Gaps

[Table 36.3](#) shows general statistics for breakaway gaps.